

Preliminary Birth Report Kansas, 2023



**Bureau of Epidemiology and Public Health Informatics
Division of Public Health**

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Our Vision – Healthy Kansans living in safe and sustainable environments.

Our Mission –To protect and improve the health and environment of all Kansans.

Introduction

This report from the Kansas Department of Health and Environment (KDHE) presents a preliminary summary of Kansas births for 2023. Selected birth counts and rates are compared to those in the *Kansas Annual Summary of Vital Statistics, 2022*. Release of preliminary statistics enables program managers and policy analysts to obtain an early picture of selected birth trends. Since full data is not available, statistics based on final counts and published in the *Kansas Annual Summary of Vital Statistics, 2023* may be slightly different.

Methods

The KDHE Bureau of Epidemiology and Public Health Informatics (BEPHI) maintains the Kansas civil registration system through the Office of Vital Statistics (OVS). All vital events that occur in Kansas are reported to OVS. Vital events occurring in other states to Kansas residents are reported to OVS via inter-state jurisdictional exchange agreements. The analysis in this research brief is based on a preliminary annual history file of births that occurred in 2023 and were registered with OVS by April 1, 2024. All data reported herein are Kansas residence data, regardless of where the event occurred.

Changes in rates or percentages referenced in this report are statistically significant unless otherwise noted. Some changes, while statistically significant, may be of such a small magnitude that they are not pertinent from a program management perspective. It is always wise to use caution when interpreting results based on small counts.

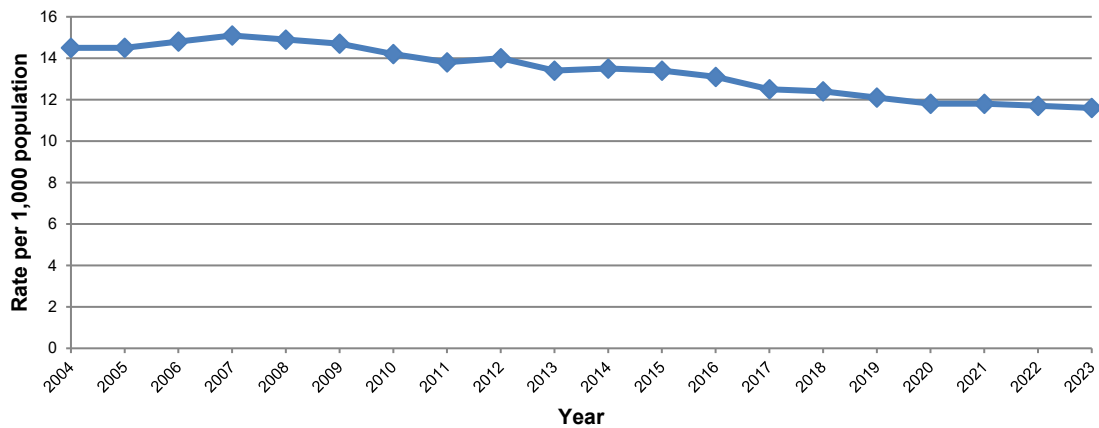
State and county birth rates use population estimates for state and county population totals as of July 1, 2023, released by the United States Census Bureau in early 2024.

Findings

As of April 1, 2024, OVS recorded 34,039 births to Kansas resident mothers in 2023, a decrease of 1.0 percent from 34,389 births in 2022. The final count may be slightly higher, since additional births may be reported for Kansas residents who gave birth in other states.

The preliminary birth rate for 2023 was 11.6 per 1,000 population, a decrease of 0.9 percent from 11.7 per 1,000 population in 2022. This is the lowest birth rate for Kansas residents since the state created a centralized Vital Records system in 1911 and is consistent with trends since 2008 (Figure 1).

**Figure 1. Birth Rates
Kansas Residents, 2004-2023**



Seven counties (Douglas, Geary, Johnson, Leavenworth, Sedgwick, Shawnee, and Wyandotte)¹ accounted for 59.8 percent of births in 2023 (Table 1), compared to 59.9 percent for these seven counties in 2022. The number of births for four of these counties was lower than in 2022. Leavenworth County births decreased by 4.1 percent (from 909 to 872), Sedgwick County births decreased by 3.7 percent (from 6,706 to 6,460), Shawnee County births decreased by 1.6 percent (from 1,902 to 1,872), and Johnson County births decreased by 0.6 percent (from 6,913 to 6,871). Geary County births increased by 7.6 percent (from 855 to 920), Douglas County births increased by 1.8 percent (from 963 to 980), and Wyandotte County births increased by 1.0 percent (from 2,358 to 2,382).

There were 12,171 births to unmarried mothers in 2023 (35.8 percent of all births where the mother's marital status was known), compared to 12,374 (36.0 percent) in 2022.

The number of births to teens aged 15-19 years decreased from 1,616 in 2022 to 1,537 in 2023. The overall percentage decreased from 4.7 percent to 4.5 percent.

There were 2,613 low birth weight (less than 2,500 grams) infants born to Kansas resident mothers in 2023 (7.7 percent of all births where the infant's birth weight was known), down from 2,706 (7.9 percent) in 2022.

Premature births (less than 37 completed weeks of gestation) decreased to 3,558 in 2023 (10.5 percent of all births where the clinical estimate of gestation was known), from 3,594 (10.5 percent) in 2022. Early-term births (37-38 weeks gestation) increased to 10,233 (30.1 percent) in 2023, from 10,179 (29.6 percent) in 2022. Full term births (39 weeks or longer gestation) decreased to 20,025 (59.5 percent) in 2023, from 20,588 (59.9 percent) in 2022.

¹ The state's six urban counties and one semi-urban county (Geary) that usually have a large number of births. Each had over 800 births in 2023.

The percentage of births where prenatal care began in the first trimester increased to 80.7 percent (27,317 births) in 2023, from 80.5 percent (27,365 births) in 2022.

Births with reported maternal cigarette smoking during pregnancy declined to 1,675 in 2023 (4.9 percent of all births where maternal cigarette status was known), down from 1,873 (5.5 percent) in 2022.

Discussion

The Kansas resident birth rate in 2023 (11.6 per 1,000 population) declined by 0.9 percent from 2022 (11.7 per 1,000 population), continuing the trend that started in 2008. During this period (2008-2023) the average annual percent change (-1.7 percent) shows a statistically significant downward trend.² The 2023 Kansas preliminary birth rate of 11.6 per 1,000 population is higher than the most current (2021 final) U.S. birth rate of 11.0.³

Based on preliminary statistics, 83.1 percent of Kansas infants were born to mothers who received adequate or better care. This surpassed the Healthy People 2030⁴ target of a minimum of 80.5 percent of infants born to mothers with adequate prenatal care (MICH-08).

The Kansas rate for live births to mothers who smoked during pregnancy in 2023 was 4.9 percent, down 10.9 percent from 5.5 percent in 2022. This does not meet the Healthy People 2030 target of no more than 4.3 percent of live births to mothers who smoked during pregnancy (objective MICH-10).

The percentage of infants born prematurely (before 37 weeks gestation) was the same in 2023 as in 2022 (10.5 percent). This is higher than the Healthy People 2030 target of no more than 9.4 percent of live births before 37 weeks gestation (objective MICH-07).

The percentage of infants born with birth weights under 2500 grams decreased by 2.5 percent, from 7.9 percent in 2022 to 7.7 percent in 2023.

Births to teens aged 15-19 years have decreased since 2009. In 2023, teen births were 4.5 percent of all births, down from 4.7 percent of all births in 2022. This was 55.9 percent less than in 2009, when teen births were 10.2 percent of all births.

The *2023 Annual Summary of Vital Statistics* will contain additional analyses, as well as the final version of the analyses presented here. It will be based on the final birth history file created in July 2024.

² National Cancer Institute Joinpoint Regression Program v3.4.5 [Internet]. Bethesda MD. [Accessed 2012 Sep 14] Available from; surveillance.cancer.gov/joinpoint/.

³ Osterman MJK, Hamilton BE, Martin JA, Driscoll AK, Valenzuela CP. Births: Final Data for 2022. National Vital Statistics Reports Vol. 73, No. 3 (April 4, 2024).

⁴ Healthy People 2030 Objectives for Pregnancy and Childbirth [Internet] [cited 2021 April 27]. Available from: health.gov/healthypeople/objectives-and-data/browse-objectives/pregnancy-and-childbirth.

Table 1. Preliminary Live Births and Rates by County of Residence, by Age of Mother, Kansas 2023

County	Total	Age-Group of Mother								n.s.	Rate†
		10-14	15-19	20-24	25-29	30-34	35-39	40-44	45 & Over		
Kansas	34,039	18	1,537	6,896	10,384	9,720	4,511	902	67	4	11.6
Allen	122	1	8	35	35	32	8	3	0	0	9.8
Anderson	104	0	2	29	31	28	11	2	1	0	13.3
Atchison	160	0	5	46	57	26	19	7	0	0	10
Barber	42	0	1	9	19	9	4	0	0	0	10.3
Barton	290	0	21	80	88	62	35	4	0	0	11.6
Bourbon	168	0	7	54	53	33	17	3	1	0	11.7
Brown	94	0	4	28	21	21	17	3	0	0	10.2
Butler	680	0	24	130	223	198	86	18	1	0	9.9
Chase	19	0	0	6	5	4	4	0	0	0	7.4
Chautauqua	38	0	4	9	10	11	3	1	0	0	11.4
Cherokee	191	0	11	57	60	46	12	5	0	0	10.0
Cheyenne	34	0	1	7	12	9	5	0	0	0	12.9
Clark	20	0	0	4	7	5	3	1	0	0	10.8
Clay	83	0	3	13	31	26	8	2	0	0	10.4
Cloud	79	0	4	17	26	24	7	1	0	0	8.9
Coffey	105	0	8	23	41	24	7	1	1	0	12.7
Comanche	22	0	0	7	7	6	2	0	0	0	13.3
Cowley	414	0	39	102	140	89	35	8	1	0	12.1
Crawford	443	0	35	98	143	103	54	9	1	0	11.4
Decatur	28	0	0	5	10	5	8	0	0	0	10.3
Dickinson	172	0	7	34	60	56	14	1	0	0	9.3
Doniphan	69	0	3	14	29	14	8	1	0	0	9.2
Douglas	980	0	32	152	295	290	165	43	1	2	8.1
Edwards	32	0	1	7	17	5	1	1	0	0	11.7
Elk	18	0	1	6	6	2	2	1	0	0	7.3
Ellis	332	0	9	54	111	90	57	11	0	0	11.5
Ellsworth	52	0	4	9	19	12	7	1	0	0	8.2
Finney	547	1	35	116	193	139	45	15	3	0	14.6
Ford	597	2	52	162	163	143	63	12	0	0	17.6
Franklin	294	1	15	76	91	74	30	5	2	0	11.3
Geary	920	0	36	336	308	157	63	17	2	1	26.3
Gove	38	0	1	8	20	6	3	0	0	0	13.9
Graham	26	0	0	6	10	5	5	0	0	0	10.9
Grant	88	0	4	32	21	25	6	0	0	0	12.3
Gray	103	0	0	22	44	23	10	4	0	0	17.9
Greeley	24	0	1	5	7	4	6	1	0	0	20.3
Greenwood	44	0	6	18	11	7	2	0	0	0	7.5
Hamilton	37	0	2	7	20	7	1	0	0	0	15.2
Harper	55	0	2	14	24	10	5	0	0	0	10.1
Harvey	381	0	21	75	131	91	47	14	2	0	11.4
Haskell	55	0	2	15	21	14	3	0	0	0	15.2
Hodgeman	15	0	0	2	7	4	2	0	0	0	9.1
Jackson	148	1	9	32	48	41	16	1	0	0	11.1
Jefferson	155	0	9	21	47	55	20	2	1	0	8.5
Jewell	31	0	2	7	11	6	5	0	0	0	10.9
Johnson	6,871	0	118	622	1,676	2,769	1,381	281	24	0	11.0
Kearny	58	0	3	13	22	12	7	1	0	0	15.2
Kingman	66	0	1	10	30	14	10	0	1	0	9.3
Kiowa	30	0	1	5	7	15	2	0	0	0	12.6
Labette	256	0	20	73	76	49	32	6	0	0	13.0
Lane	25	0	0	7	9	4	4	1	0	0	16.4
Leavenworth	872	0	28	146	253	298	124	22	1	0	10.4
Lincoln	24	0	2	5	11	3	2	1	0	0	8.2
Linn	98	0	3	22	43	17	13	0	0	0	9.9
Logan	36	0	3	10	13	5	4	1	0	0	13.5
Lyon	347	0	22	100	99	82	35	9	0	0	10.8
McPherson	282	0	7	52	95	89	34	5	0	0	9.4
Marion	128	0	6	26	43	37	15	1	0	0	10.9
Marshall	88	0	4	19	29	25	9	2	0	0	8.9
Meade	52	0	1	9	23	10	8	1	0	0	13.3

Table 1. Preliminary Live Births and Rates by County of Residence, by Age of Mother, Kansas 2023

County	Total	Age-Group of Mother								Rate [†]
		10-14	15-19	20-24	25-29	30-34	35-39	40-44	45 & Over	
Miami	416	0	10	61	126	150	59	10	0	11.8
Mitchell	64	0	0	14	27	18	3	2	0	11.2
Montgomery	292	1	23	86	80	71	29	2	0	9.6
Morris	55	0	3	8	19	21	4	0	0	10.3
Morton	29	0	1	10	9	6	3	0	0	11.2
Nemaha	139	0	1	18	58	48	12	1	1	13.7
Neosho	213	0	13	72	67	33	22	5	1	13.8
Ness	31	0	2	6	10	8	4	1	0	11.8
Norton	53	0	2	15	18	15	3	0	0	9.9
Osage	151	1	6	37	59	29	18	1	0	9.5
Osborne	40	0	3	8	9	12	6	2	0	11.7
Ottawa	53	0	0	9	23	15	5	1	0	9.1
Pawnee	54	0	1	14	17	18	3	1	0	8.8
Phillips	55	0	2	13	19	17	3	1	0	11.6
Pottawatomie	378	0	3	67	126	107	63	12	0	14.3
Pratt	95	0	5	17	39	27	7	0	0	10.5
Rawlins	28	0	0	7	7	8	4	1	1	11.4
Reno	655	0	39	177	206	153	64	13	3	10.7
Republic	41	0	3	6	9	15	7	1	0	8.9
Rice	96	0	2	26	36	24	8	0	0	10.4
Riley	737	0	28	188	236	186	86	12	1	10.3
Rooks	43	0	0	8	24	8	3	0	0	9.0
Rush	24	0	1	8	8	5	1	1	0	8.5
Russell	75	0	3	16	23	22	8	3	0	11.2
Saline	581	1	30	156	170	148	62	14	0	10.9
Scott	66	0	3	12	28	16	7	0	0	13.4
Sedgwick	6,460	5	319	1,398	2,055	1,737	785	154	6	12.2
Seward	361	3	27	87	115	73	48	7	1	17.1
Shawnee	1,872	0	120	447	587	457	212	47	2	10.5
Sheridan	36	0	1	4	18	11	2	0	0	14.9
Sherman	62	0	3	12	17	23	6	1	0	10.6
Smith	38	0	0	11	13	8	5	1	0	10.6
Stafford	60	0	2	14	13	17	13	1	0	15.3
Stanton	24	0	2	4	7	9	1	1	0	12.6
Stevens	56	0	2	21	14	16	2	1	0	11.0
Sumner	237	0	9	54	91	56	25	2	0	10.6
Thomas	110	0	3	21	36	35	11	3	1	14.0
Trego	27	0	2	5	8	8	4	0	0	9.9
Wabaunsee	55	0	1	8	23	12	7	4	0	7.8
Wallace	23	0	0	5	7	7	4	0	0	15.2
Washington	66	0	0	6	19	28	9	2	2	12
Wichita	31	0	1	8	11	10	1	0	0	14.9
Wilson	70	0	9	21	22	12	5	1	0	8.4
Woodson	23	0	2	8	7	3	2	1	0	7.4
Wyandotte	2,382	1	200	595	706	548	264	63	5	14.4
n.s. [‡]	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	n/a
Peer Group										
Frontier	1,244	0	50	285	444	301	143	20	1	11.5
Rural	2,606	0	96	573	933	701	256	40	7	10.8
Densely - Settled Rural	5,353	9	313	1,295	1,721	1,288	601	118	8	12.2
Semi-Urban	5,399	3	261	1,383	1,714	1,331	580	114	12	11.9
Urban	19,437	6	817	3,360	5,572	6,099	2,931	610	39	11.4

* Based on 2023 births registered by April 1, 2024

† Rates are per 1,000 population.

‡ Some records without valid county data may be deleted from the final history file or may be assigned to a Kansas county based on other address information in the record.